Experiment 06 - Workflow and Automation in Zoho Creator

Aim

To design and document workflow automation for the Student Admission Enquiry Management application in Zoho Creator, including form-triggered actions, scheduled reminders, approvals, payment workflows, blueprints, batch operations, and reusable Deluge functions.

Theory

Zoho Creator workflows automate form validation, notifications, approvals, and status transitions. Scheduling supports time-based operations; blueprints define controlled lifecycle steps; batch workflows act on groups of imported records; and custom Deluge functions make automation logic reusable. The configured workflows can help admission staff verify enquiries, arrange counselling, and coordinate follow-up activities.

Workflow Options Used Overview

Workflow option	Project workflow	Purpose / configuration visible
Form workflows	Notify Applicant; DOB_Validation; Scholarship_Percent_Validation; EnquirySubmittedOn	Submission notification, validation, and enquiry timestamp handling. Four enabled entries shown.
Schedules	Daily_Counselling_Reminder_Schedule	Enabled reminder schedule; screenshot currently shows 0 actions.
Approvals	Admission Approval Workflow	Enabled approval process with 2 actions, triggered on review.
Payments	Application_Fee_Payment_Workflow	Enabled 2-action payment workflow; payment gateway not yet configured.
Blueprints	Admission_Lifecycle_Blueprint	Enabled lifecycle blueprint for admission processing.
Batch workflows	Bulk_Admission_Notification_Batch	Enabled batch workflow with trigger shown as after successful import.
Functions	Send_Counselling_Reminder	Custom Deluge function with void return type.

Procedure

1. Open the Student Admission Enquiry Management application in Zoho Creator and select the Workflow tab.
2. Under Form workflows, configure Notify Applicant for successful submission and validate date of birth and scholarship percentage; include the EnquirySubmittedOn action.
3. Under Schedules, create the Daily_Counselling_Reminder_Schedule. Add the reminder action before relying on automatic emails.
4. Under Approvals, configure Admission Approval Workflow for review-stage decision making.
5. Under Payments, create Application_Fee_Payment_Workflow. Configure a supported payment gateway separately to process online transactions.
6. Under Blueprints, create and enable Admission_Lifecycle_Blueprint for admission-stage progression.
7. Under Batch workflows, configure Bulk_Admission_Notification_Batch to operate after successful import.
8. Under Functions, create the Deluge function Send_Counselling_Reminder for reuse in reminder actions.
9. Review each workflow status and test triggers, messaging, approval decisions, and payment handling as applicable.

Screenshots

Figure 1. Form workflows: enabled admission notification, validation, and timestamp workflows

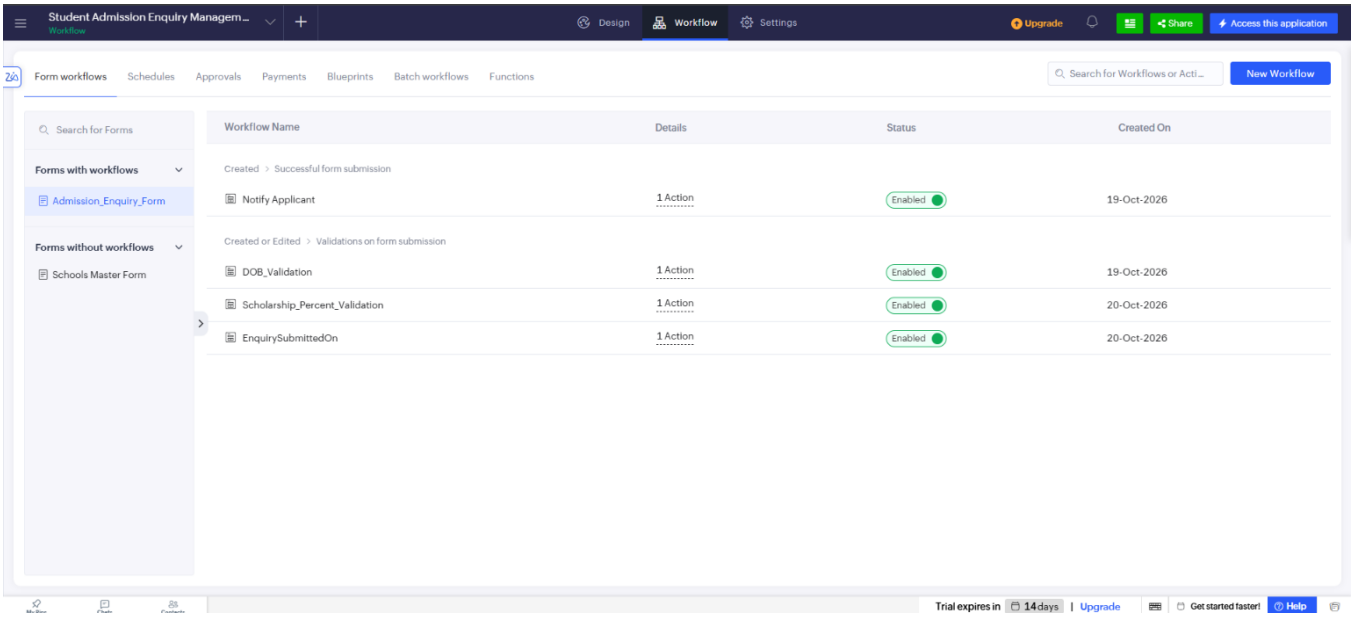


Figure 2. Schedules: counselling reminder schedule (0 actions shown)

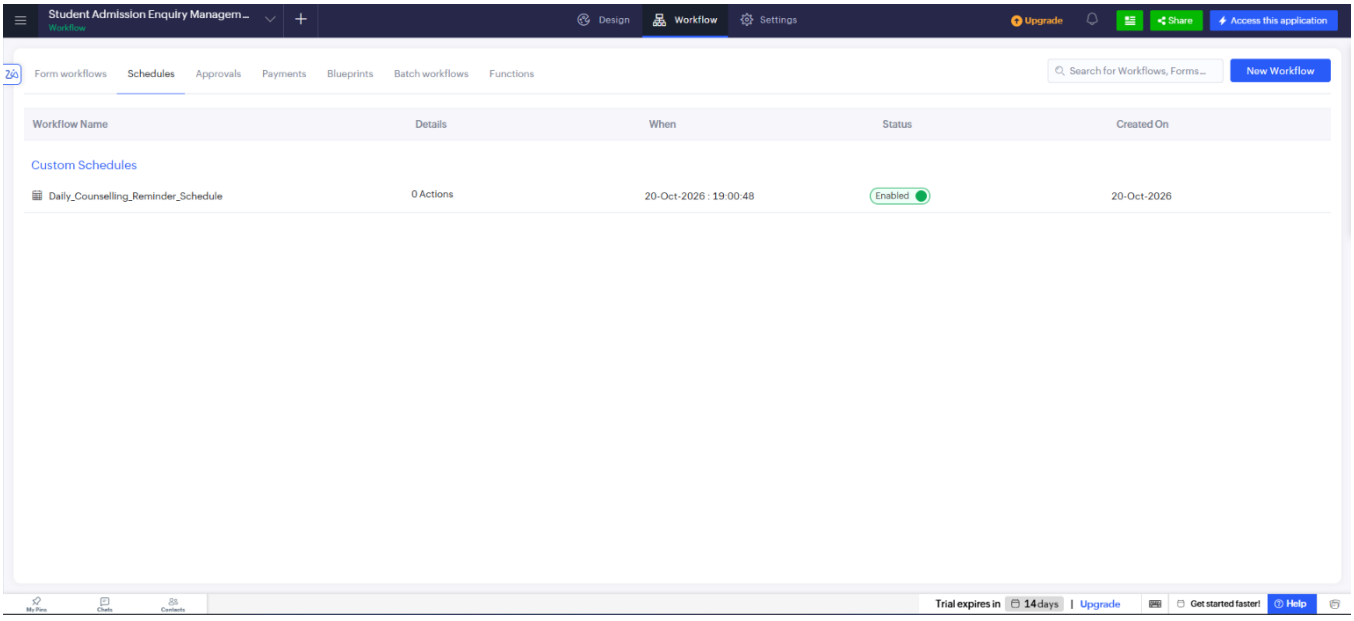


Figure 3. Approvals: Admission Approval Workflow

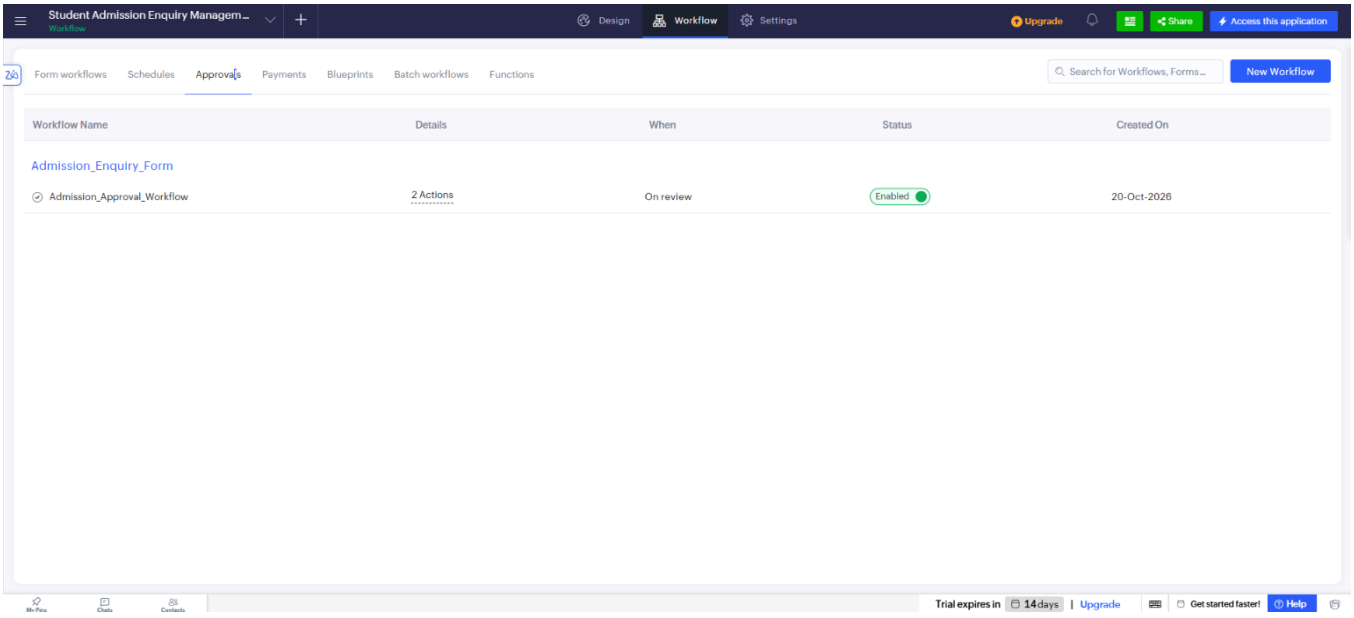


Figure 4. Payments: payment workflow; gateway configuration notice

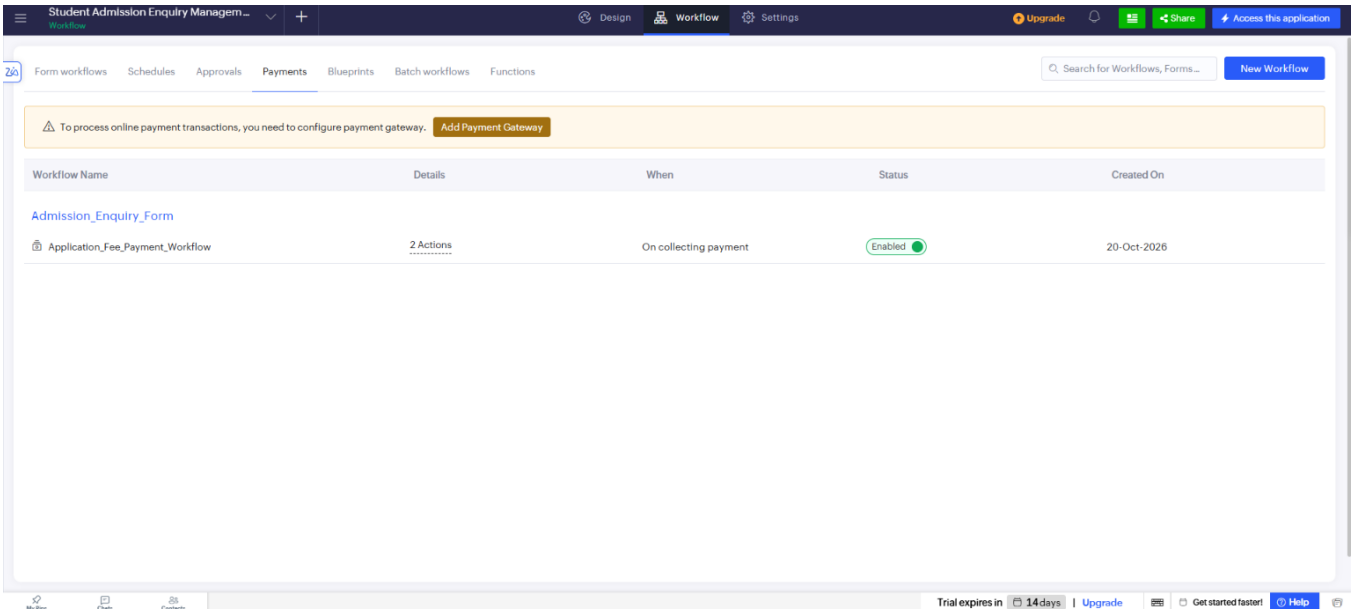


Figure 5. Blueprints: Admission Lifecycle Blueprint

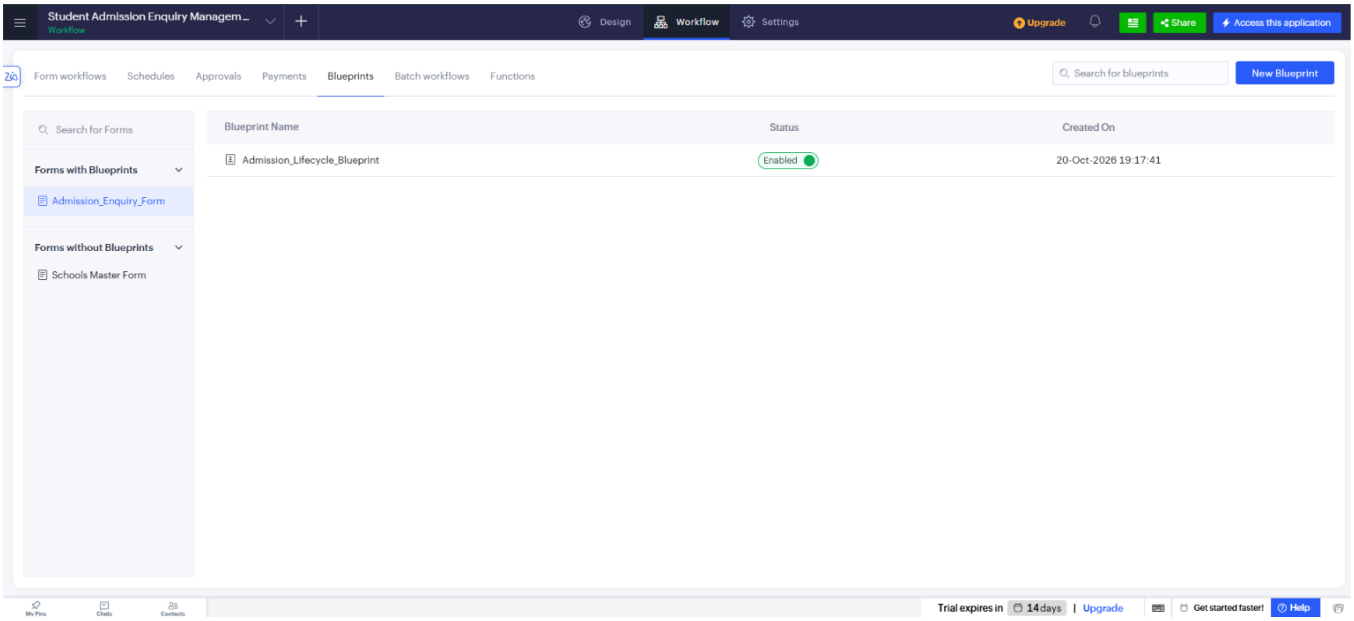


Figure 6. Batch workflows: Bulk Admission Notification Batch

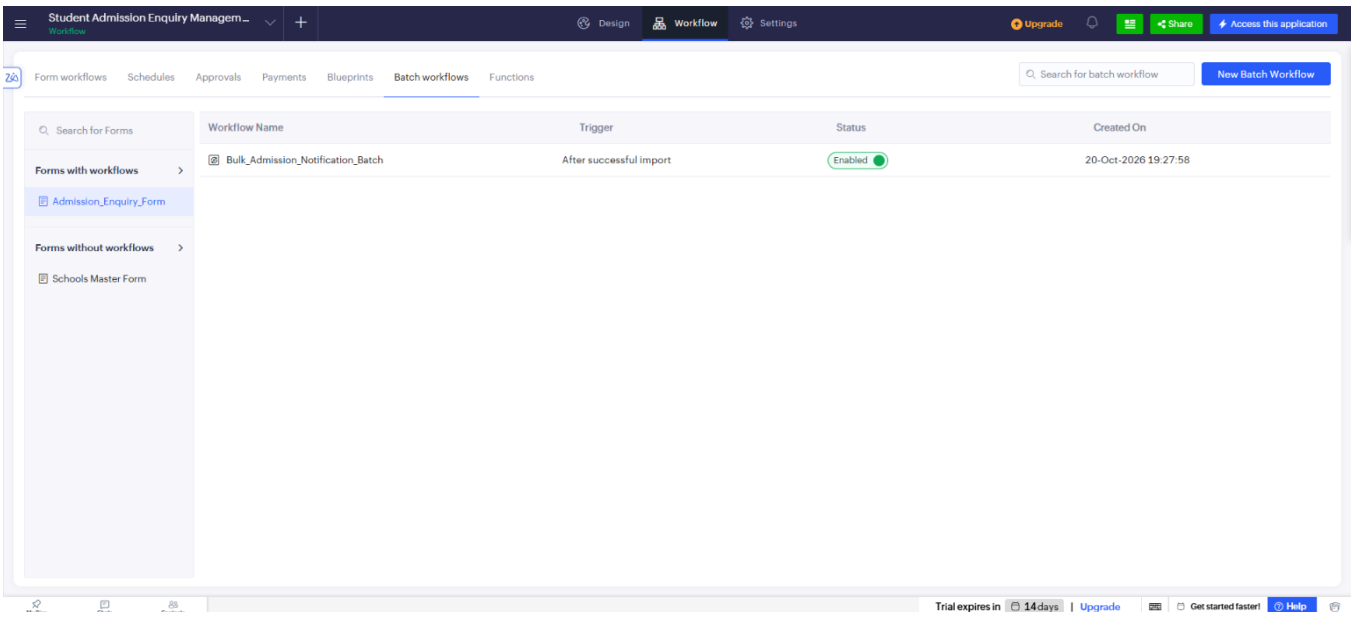
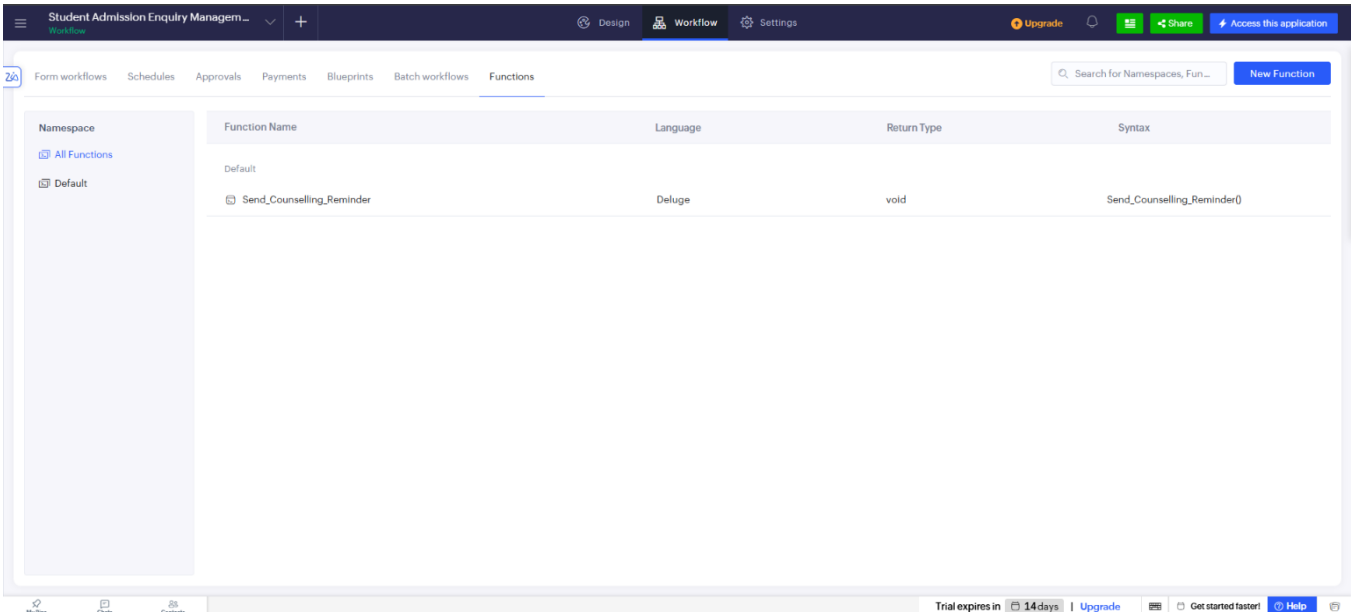


Figure 7. Functions: Send Counselling Reminder (Deluge)



Result

The Student Admission Enquiry Management application was documented with enabled form workflows, a schedule, an approval workflow, a payment workflow, a blueprint, a batch workflow, and a custom Deluge function. The screenshots verify their presence in the Zoho Creator interface. The schedule currently displays zero actions, and the payment tab indicates that a payment gateway must be configured; successful reminder delivery, payment collection, and end-to-end execution have not been established by these screenshots.